ON ECONOMY

“UNDER MY PLAN, AMERICAN WORKERS WILL NO LONGER BE WORRIED ABOUT LOSING YOUR JOBS TO FOREIGN NATIONS. INSTEAD, FOREIGN NATIONS WILL BE WORRIED ABOUT LOSING THEIR JOBS TO AMERICA....”

“WE WILL SET UP SPECIAL ZONES OF FEDERAL LAND WITH ULTRA LOW TAXES AND REGULATIONS FOR AMERICAN PRODUCERS... AND APPOINT A MANUFACTURING AMBASSADOR WHOSE SOLE TASK...WILL BE TO GO AROUND THE WORLD AND CONVINCE MAJOR MANUFACTURERS TO PACK UP AND MOVE BACK TO AMERICA”

—Sept. 25, Savannah, Georgia

PLANET TRUMP

President-elect Donald Trump’s basketful of promises on the economy, immigration, protecting US jobs through tariffs and on foreign affairs helped him win the election. These are his recent pronouncements, delivered with trademark swagger



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AT THE HIGH TABLE

President Donald Trump with other world leaders at the 2019 G20 summit in Osaka, Japan

when he formally assumes office on January 20, 2025. Much of the world waits with trepidation for, as Ashley Tellis, senior fellow at the Washington DC-based Carnegie Endowment for International Peace and a top expert on Indo-US relations, puts it, “We are going to have a tumultuous presidency. Trump is going to come with much greater confidence and with an army of acolytes and foot soldiers who regard him as an apostle of a revolution. They are determined to take an axe to the roots. He will do things no previous American president would have even contemplated doing. There will be serious perturbations in terms of the traditional American role in hegemonic stability.”

In his second term, as in his first, Trump’s domestic agenda will be his most compelling concern, and his foreign policy will be subservient to the radical reforms he has in mind for his country. During his campaign for re-election, Trump’s team brought out a manifesto called ‘Agenda 47’, which listed a range of major policy initiatives, domestic and foreign, that he would implement, even if it meant trampling on the powers of the US Congress. These include a radical downsizing of government bureaucracy and restructuring of administrative appointments, to fire those he calls “rogue bureaucrats” and make way for those aligned to his policy. In the US Department of Justice, for instance, Trump has pledged to appoint 100 US attorneys to fight, among other things, anti-conservative bias and left-leaning law firms. On crime, he has promised to be tough and bring in the death penalty for human traffickers, drug dealers and cartels.

Trump’s plans in other spheres have elicited equal consternation domestically. In education, for example, among the initiatives listed is a plan to get rid of existing accreditors for colleges and universities and replace them with ones more in line with the Republican party values. Professor Sumit Ganguly, a senior fellow at the Hoover Foundation at Stanford University, describes much of what Trump is planning as “a domestic Reaganite revolution on steroids”. Ronald Reagan, one of the best recent Republican presidents of America, brought about a major economic revival during his tenure between 1981 and 1989 by lowering taxes and freeing the economy of bureaucratic constraints, besides undertaking some path-breaking initiatives to tackle the Cold War. But